

A Note on Rainfall Records from Three Hill Stations

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Abstract

We describe daily rainfall records kept at three hill stations between 1961 and 2010 and report simple statistics for each decade.

Introduction

Long rainfall records from hill stations are scarce. The three stations described here were run by tea estates, whose managers wrote the daily total in a ledger each morning. The ledgers were typed into spreadsheets by the author during 2021.

Data and Methods

Each station used a standard 203 mm gauge read at 08:30 local time. Days on which the ledger entry was illegible were marked as missing; they make up 1.2% of all days. Decadal means were computed from complete years only.

Results

Mean annual rainfall was 2,610 mm, 3,140 mm and 2,275 mm at the three stations. The wettest decade at all three was 1981 to 1990. The number of days with more than 100 mm rose from 3.1 per year in the 1960s to 4.6 per year in the 2000s.

The monsoon months of June to September account for 71% of the annual total at the wettest station and 64% at the driest.

References

Guhathakurta, P. and Rajeevan, M. (2008). Trends in the rainfall pattern over India. *International Journal of Climatology*, 28, 1453-1469.